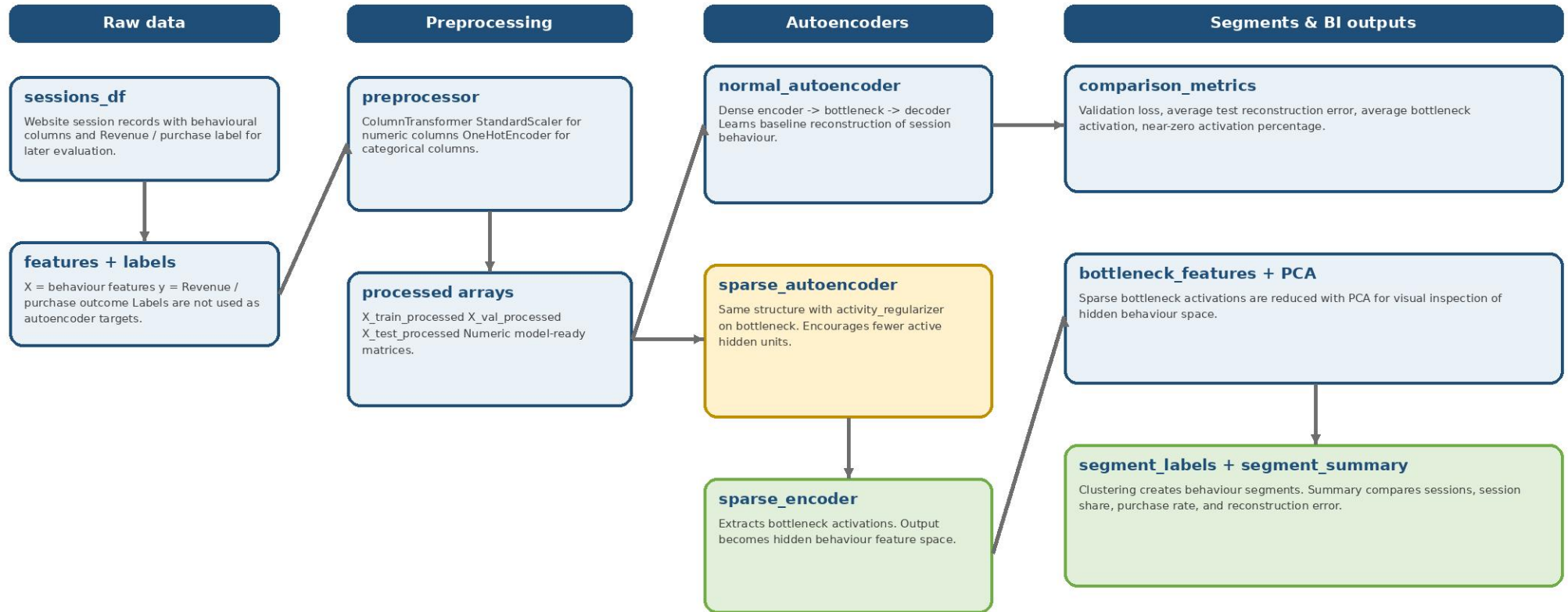


Sparse Autoencoder - Variable / Method Flow

Flowchart of the main variables and methods used in the sparse autoencoder notebook



How to read this flow

- The autoencoder target is the same processed feature matrix. It does not use purchase / Revenue as the training target.
- The sparse autoencoder adds a regularization penalty to encourage compact bottleneck activations.
- The sparse bottleneck is useful because it turns noisy session behaviour into fewer hidden behaviour signals.
- PCA and clustering are interpretation tools after representation learning, not the core autoencoder training step.
- Business interpretation comes from comparing segments using purchase rate, session volume, and reconstruction error.

Mini glossary

Sparse bottleneck: compressed layer with fewer active units Activation: hidden unit output PCA: 2D visualisation Segment: cluster of similar sessions